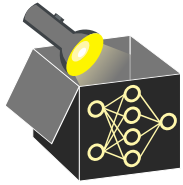
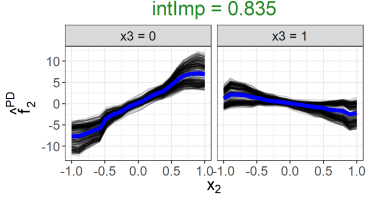
Interpretable Machine Learning



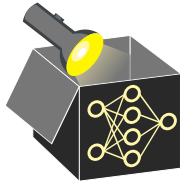
Regional Effects
Interaction importance



Learning goals

- Interaction quantification
- REPID interaction importance

INTERACTION QUANTIFICATION

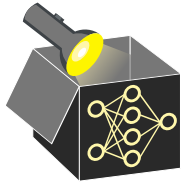


It's helpful to know not just how another feature changes the marginal effect of x_S but how strong that interaction is and want to rank features by it.

Approaches:

- **H-Statistics:** Variance of the deviation between the joint PDP and the sum of marginal PDPs (larger variance $\Rightarrow$ stronger interaction).
- **Greenwell's Interaction Index:** Difference between variance of the PDP and the mean variance of centered ICE curves for the same feature pair.
- **SHAP interaction index (** "Herbinger et al." 2022 **,** "Lundberg et al." 2018 **):** Proportion of all two-way interactions with x_i to which the j-th feature contributes.

INTERACTION QUANTIFICATION



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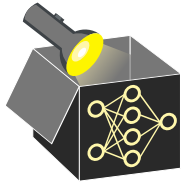
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Pitfalls:

- The values of H-Statistic and the Greenwell's Interaction Index are influenced by the main effects of the two regarded features.
- SHAP interaction index does not suffer from main effect problem. However, correlation between the two features can bias the interaction value. Same applies to the H-Statistic.

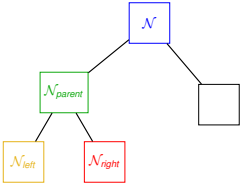
REPID INTERACTION IMPORTANCE



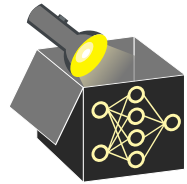
On parent node level (for $\mathcal{N}_{parent}$):

$$intImp(\mathcal{N}_{parent}) = \frac{\mathcal{R}(\mathcal{N}_{parent}) - (\mathcal{R}(\mathcal{N}_{left}) + \mathcal{R}(\mathcal{N}_{right}))}{\mathcal{R}(\mathcal{N})}$$

Interpretation: Reduction of ICE curve variance after one split of $\mathcal{N}_{parent}$ into $\mathcal{N}_{left}$ and $\mathcal{N}_{right}$ relative to the ICE curve variance in the root node $\mathcal{N}$.



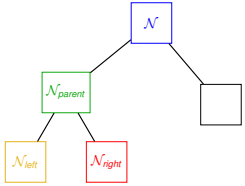
REPID INTERACTION IMPORTANCE

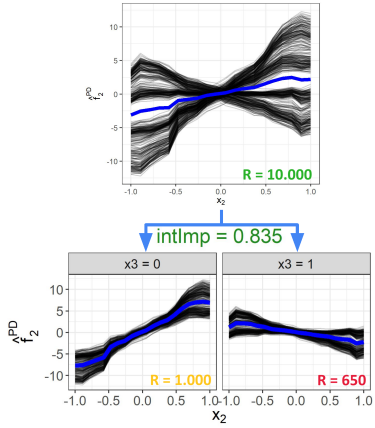


On parent node level (for $\mathcal{N}_{parent}$):

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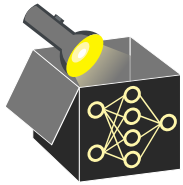
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Split reduces 83.5% of variance.

REPID INTERACTION IMPORTANCE



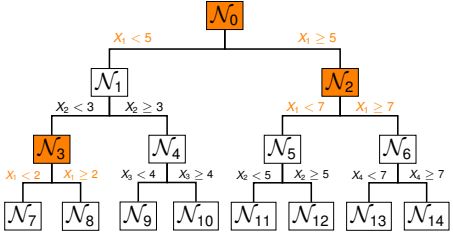
On feature level (for x_j):

$$intImp_j = \sum_{i \in \mathcal{B}_j} intImp(\mathcal{N}_i)$$

where $\mathcal{B}_j$ indexes parent nodes split by x_j.

Interpretation: Overall reduction of ICE curve variance due to splits by X_j (in %).

Example: For $X_1 \Rightarrow \mathcal{B}_1 = \{0, 2, 3\}$



REPID INTERACTION IMPORTANCE

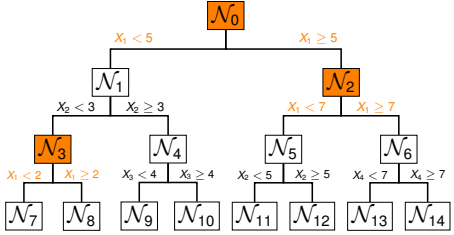
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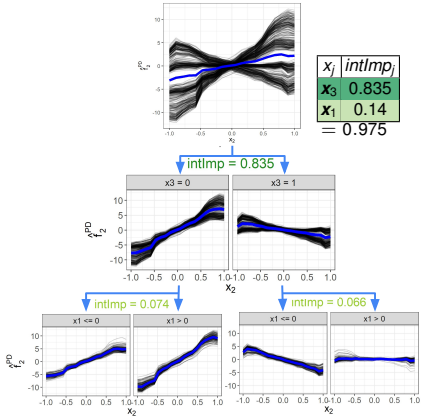
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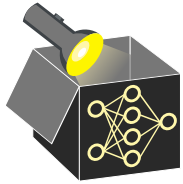
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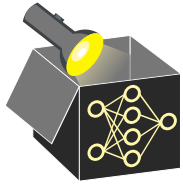


x_j	$intImp_j$
x_3	0.835
x_1	0.14
	= 0.975

Note: *intImp* can also be used as a stopping criterion.



OUTPERFORMING SOTA



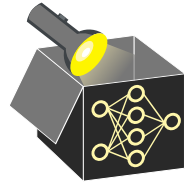
Simulation setting

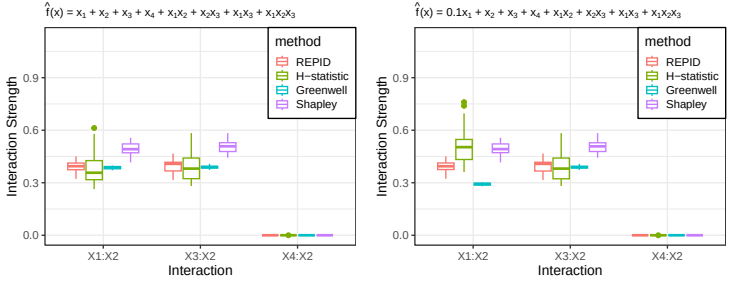
- Draw 1000 i.i.d. samples from $X_1, \ldots, X_4 \sim \mathcal{U}(-1, 1)$
- True underlying function: $f(\boldsymbol{x}) = \sum_{j=1}^{4} \boldsymbol{x}_j + \boldsymbol{x}_1\boldsymbol{x}_2 + \boldsymbol{x}_2\boldsymbol{x}_3 + \boldsymbol{x}_1\boldsymbol{x}_3 + \boldsymbol{x}_1\boldsymbol{x}_2\boldsymbol{x}_3 + \epsilon$
- Fit a correctly specified linear model (interactions with $\boldsymbol{x}_4$ are excluded)
- 30 reps, measure interaction strength between $\boldsymbol{x}_2$ and all other 3 features

Which methods are sensitive to changes in main effect sizes or feature correlations?

Pitfall	REPID	H-Statistic	Greenwell	SHAP
sensitive to changes of main effect	No	Yes	Yes	No
sensitive to changes of correlation between $\boldsymbol{x}_j$ and other features	No	Yes	No	Yes

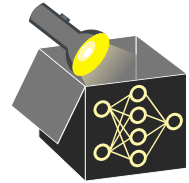
OUTPERFORMING SOTA

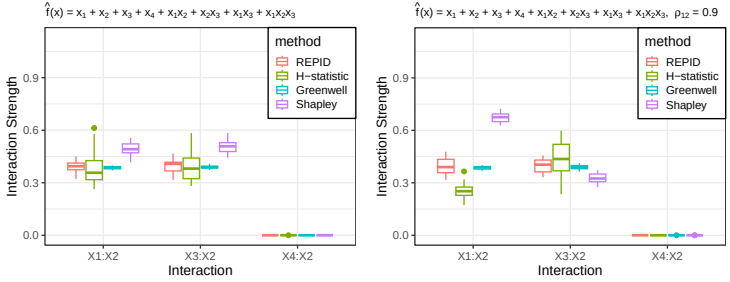




- **Left (initial setting)**: Interaction strength of $\boldsymbol{x}_1$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$ and $\boldsymbol{x}_3$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$ similar; $\boldsymbol{x}_4$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$ no interaction
- **Right**: Set main effect $\beta_1 = 0.1$
  - **Expectation**: Interaction strengths should not change
  - **Fail**: H-statistic ($\boldsymbol{x}_1$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$ > $\boldsymbol{x}_3$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$) and Greenwell ($\boldsymbol{x}_1$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$ < $\boldsymbol{x}_3$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$)

OUTPERFORMING SOTA



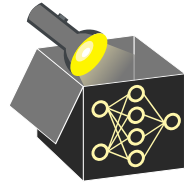


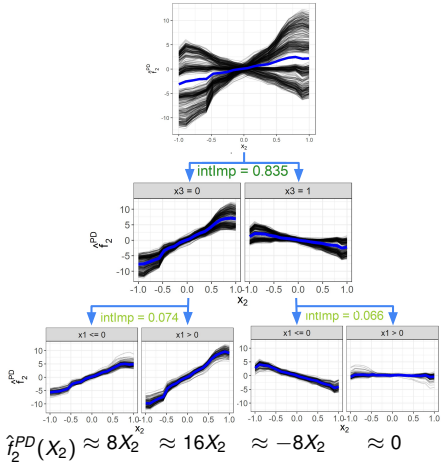
- **Left (initial setting)**: Interaction strength of $\boldsymbol{x}_1$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$ and $\boldsymbol{x}_3$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$ similar; $\boldsymbol{x}_4$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$ no interaction
- **Right**: Increase correlation $\rho(\boldsymbol{x}_1, \boldsymbol{x}_2) = 0.9$
  - **Expectation**: Interaction strengths should not change
  - **Fail**: H-statistic ($\boldsymbol{x}_1$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$ < $\boldsymbol{x}_3$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$) and Shapley ($\boldsymbol{x}_1$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$ > $\boldsymbol{x}_3$:$\boldsymbol{x}_2$)

$\rightarrow$ **REPID is the only method which always leads to correct rankings for these settings**

LIMITATIONS OF REPID

1) Restricted to one feature of interest
$\Rightarrow$ Different regions for different features





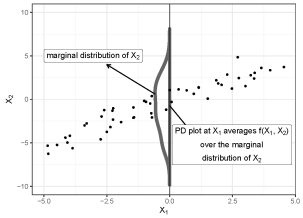
$\hat{f}_2^{PD}(X_2) \approx 8X_2 \quad \approx 16X_2 \quad \approx -8X_2 \quad \approx 0$

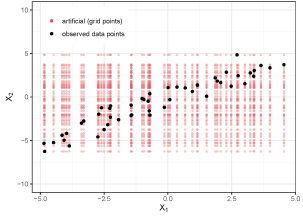
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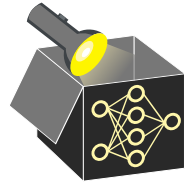
1) Restricted to one feature of interest
$\Rightarrow$ Different regions for different features

2) Restricted to PD (global) and ICE (local) as feature effect methods
$\Rightarrow$ Inherits extrapolation problem (unlikely combinations of feature values)

$\rightsquigarrow$ Follow-up GADGET [under review]







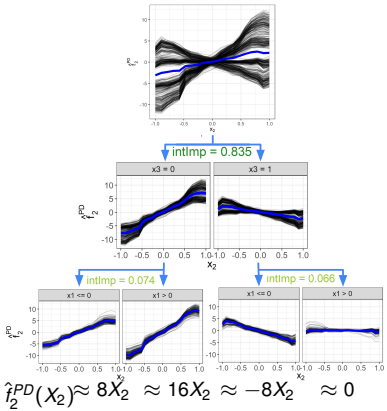
CONCLUSION

Summary of Contributions (REPID):

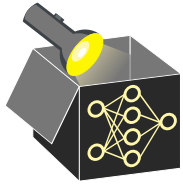
- Regional effects in interpretable regions
- Additive decomp. of feature effect
- Quantify feature interactions
- Outperforms SOTA interaction indices

Summary of Contributions (GADGET):

- Unique regions for multiple features
- Additive decomp. of prediction function
- Extension to ALE and Shapley Dependence
- Test to identify significant interactions



$$\hat{f}_2^{PD}(x_2) \approx 8x_2 \quad \approx 16x_2 \quad \approx -8x_2 \quad \approx 0$$



Further Directions:

Pruning, GADGET as a predictor, comparing regions across models, efficient implementation, more efficient testing and splitting approach, . . .